

The Underground House in Ward, Colorado, was a subterranean dwelling which was designed by architect Julian "Jay" Swayze (1923–1981) in the 1960s. It was included in the Underground World Home exhibit at the 1964 New York World's Fair.

History

In 1962, Jay Swayze, a Texas contractor, was asked by the city of Plainview, Texas to construct an underground home using government civil-defense plans. Swayze, appaled by the request, began to build a 2,800 square feet (260 m2) underground ranch house which he called the "Atomitat", a play on the words "Atomic" and "Habitat".

Girard Henderson, director of Avon Products, visited this bomb shelter and commissioned Swayze and his brother, Kenneth Swayze, to build another underground home in Colorado for himself. In exchange, Henderson helped founded the Underground World Home Corporation, bought 51% of the shares and helped finance building an underground house for an exhibit at the 1964 World's Fair in New York.

See also

[Underground World Home](#)

[Underground living](#)

References

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